

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): Confined Space Entry

Revision Date: 2025-07-02

Training Interval: 78 months

1. Purpose

To establish safe procedures for entry into confined spaces at [Facility Name], ensuring the safety of all personnel involved.

2. Definition: Confined Space

A confined space is an area that:

- Is large enough for an employee to enter and perform assigned work,
- Has limited or restricted means for entry or exit,
- Is not designed for continuous occupancy.

Examples:

- Storage tanks
 - Silos
 - Pits
 - Vessels
 - Ductwork
 - Sewers
 - Boilers
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3. Permit-Required Confined Space Entry

A permit-required confined space (PRCS) has one or more of the following:

- Contains or has potential to contain a hazardous atmosphere,
- Contains a material with potential for engulfment,
- Has an internal configuration that could trap or asphyxiate,
- Contains any other recognized serious safety or health hazard.

No entry is permitted without a completed and authorized Confined Space Entry Permit.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

A. Entrant

- Review and understand permit and hazards
- Use required PPE

- Maintain communication with Attendant
- Exit space immediately upon order or alarm

B. Attendant

- Remain outside the space at all times
- Monitor Entrants and environment
- Maintain communication
- Initiate emergency response if needed
- Prevent unauthorized entry

C. Entry Supervisor

- Verify permit completion and accuracy
 - Ensure all pre-entry requirements are met
 - Authorize entry and cancel permit as needed
 - Ensure emergency procedures are in place
 - Remove personnel if unsafe conditions arise
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5. Pre-Entry Requirements

- Complete Confined Space Entry Permit
 - Identify and isolate all energy sources (lockout/tagout)
 - Test atmosphere for oxygen, flammable gases, and toxic vapors
 - Ventilate space as needed to maintain safe atmosphere
 - Ensure all required PPE is available and used
 - Set up barriers and warning signs
 - Review emergency and rescue procedures
 - Assign and brief all roles (Entrant, Attendant, Supervisor)
 - Ensure communication devices are functional
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6. During Entry Procedures

- Continuous atmospheric monitoring
- Maintain ventilation

- Entrants and Attendant maintain constant communication
 - No unauthorized personnel allowed entry
 - Attendant monitors for signs of distress or hazards
 - Entry Supervisor available for consultation
 - Permit displayed at entry point
 - Immediate evacuation if alarm or unsafe condition occurs
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7. Emergency Response Plan

- Attendant initiates emergency response (alarm, call 911, notify onsite rescue team)
 - No entry for rescue without proper training and equipment
 - Use retrieval systems (tripod, harness, lifeline) if feasible
 - Provide first aid/CPR as trained and required
 - Supervisor to coordinate with emergency responders
 - Complete incident report after event
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8. Required Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Hard hat
- Safety glasses/goggles
- Chemical-resistant gloves
- Steel-toed boots
- Flame-resistant clothing (as required)
- Hearing protection (as required)
- Respiratory protection (as required by atmospheric testing)

- Full body harness with lifeline (if retrieval system is used)
- Portable gas detector

9. Confined Space Entry Permit Checklist

Item	Yes	No
Permit completed and authorized	☐	☐
Space identified and labeled	☐	☐
All energy sources locked/tagged out	☐	☐
Atmospheric testing completed (O2, LEL, toxic gases)	☐	☐
Acceptable atmospheric conditions confirmed	☐	☐
Continuous monitoring equipment in place	☐	☐
Ventilation established and operational	☐	☐
Barriers and warning signs posted	☐	☐
Required PPE available and worn	☐	☐
Communication devices tested and functional	☐	☐
Rescue and emergency equipment available	☐	☐
Attendant assigned and briefed	☐	☐
Entrant(s) assigned and briefed	☐	☐
Entry Supervisor assigned and briefed	☐	☐
Emergency response plan reviewed	☐	☐
Permit posted at entry point	☐	☐

End of SOP